

ANALYSTLAB AFRICA
EXPERIENCE LAB INTERNSHIP PROGRAMME

HEALTHCONNECT CLINIC EXPERIENCE LAB

COMMUNICATION MANAGEMENT APPROACH

Improving Patient Appointment Attendance and Healthcare Support Using Data and AI

Document Control

Project	HealthConnect Clinic Experience Lab
Programme	AnalystLab Africa Experience Lab
Document Type	Communication Management Approach
Version	1.0
Project Phase	Initiation / Planning
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Status	Initial Baseline
Owner	Project Management Function

1. COMMUNICATION MANAGEMENT OBJECTIVE

Establish a controlled communication framework that ensures timely information flow, effective stakeholder engagement, cross-workstream coordination, decision traceability and appropriate escalation throughout the project lifecycle.

Communication will support five core management functions:

- Governance
- Delivery coordination
- Decision-making
- Risk and dependency control
- Stakeholder engagement

2. COMMUNICATION MANAGEMENT PRINCIPLES

Principle	Application
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Principle	Application
Purpose-driven	Every formal communication should have a defined information or decision purpose.
Audience-specific	Content, detail and channel should reflect stakeholder authority and information requirements.
Timely	Information should be communicated early enough to support effective action.
Evidence-based	Status, risks, decisions and recommendations should distinguish verified information from assumptions.
Traceable	Material decisions, approvals, changes and escalations should have a documented record.
Exception-focused	Material deviations should be escalated immediately rather than deferred to routine reporting.
Controlled	Sensitive project and patient-related information should be distributed only through authorised channels.
Integrated	Communication should connect workstream outputs, dependencies and decisions rather than operate as isolated reporting.

3. STAKEHOLDER COMMUNICATION MATRIX

ID	Stakeholder / Audience	Information Requirement	Communication Purpose	Primary Channel	Cadence / Trigger	Accountable Owner
C-01	HealthConnect Clinic Management	Project performance, major risks, dependencies, resource implications, decisions and value	<i>Strategic governance</i>	Management Review / Status Report	Stage gates + material exceptions	Project Manager
C-02	Project Sponsor / Leadership	Overall status, major deviations, escalations, scope changes and strategic decisions	<i>Direction and escalation</i>	Executive Status Report / Review	Milestones + exception	Project Manager
C-03	Project Management Team	Schedule, deliverables, risks, dependencies, issues, decisions and actions	<i>Project control</i>	Project Control Meeting / Dashboard	Weekly	Project Manager
C-04	Workstream Leads	Requirements, interfaces, dependencies, decisions, blockers and upcoming milestones	<i>Integration and coordination</i>	Coordination Meeting / Shared Tracker	Weekly + exception	Project Manager
C-05	Clinic & Administrative Staff	Current/future workflows, requirements, proposed changes, testing outcomes and operational impacts	<i>Operational alignment</i>	Workshop / Briefing	Phase-specific	Project Manager + Relevant Lead
C-06	Healthcare Professionals	Patient-support implications, escalation requirements, workflow impacts and validation findings	<i>Service and operational assurance</i>	Review Session / Briefing	Relevant design and validation stages	Project Manager + Relevant Lead
C-07	Data & Analytics Team	Data requirements, quality findings, analytical priorities and dependencies	<i>Analytical delivery</i>	Technical Working Session / Shared Documentation	Workstream cadence	Analytics Lead
C-08	AI/ML Team	Analytical findings, model requirements, dependencies, evaluation criteria and decisions	<i>Predictive solution delivery</i>	Technical Working Session	Development + validation	AI/ML Lead

ID	Stakeholder / Audience	Information Requirement	Communication Purpose	Primary Channel	Cadence / Trigger	Accountable Owner
C-09	Generative AI Team	Support requirements, approved information sources, guardrails, escalation rules and validation findings	<i>AI-support delivery</i>	Technical Working Session	Design + development + validation	GenAI Lead
C-10	Testing & Validation Team	Acceptance criteria, solution changes, test results, defects and resolution status	<i>Quality assurance</i>	Test Review / Defect Log	Testing cycle + exception	Testing Lead
C-11	Implementation / Adoption Team	Workflow changes, readiness gaps, training requirements and adoption considerations	<i>Transition planning</i>	Readiness Workshop / Report	Implementation planning	Implementation Lead
C-12	Data Protection / Responsible AI Oversight	Data-use requirements, privacy risks, AI controls and assurance findings	<i>Governance and assurance</i>	Formal Review / Controlled Documentation	Relevant stage gates + exception	Project Manager + Relevant Lead
C-13	Patients / End Users	Approved appointment information, support guidance and feedback opportunities	<i>Engagement and validation</i>	Approved Patient-Facing Channel	Intervention / testing trigger	Patient Engagement Lead

4. PROJECT COMMUNICATION CADENCE

Communication Event	Primary Function	Participants	Frequency / Trigger	Required Output
Workstream Review	Activity and dependency control	Workstream Leads	<i>Weekly</i>	Updated actions, risks and dependencies
Project Control Review	Integrated project control	Project Manager + Workstream Leads	<i>Weekly</i>	Consolidated project position
Stakeholder Review	Requirements, findings and feedback	Relevant Stakeholders	<i>Phase / milestone based</i>	Decisions and actions
Stage-Gate Review	Readiness and progression decision	Sponsor + Relevant Leads	<i>Defined stage gates</i>	Gate decision
Exception Review	Resolution of material deviations	Relevant Decision Authority	<i>As required</i>	Resolution / escalation
Closure Review	Outcome and deliverable acceptance	Project Leadership + Workstream Leads	<i>Project close</i>	Closure decision

5. PROJECT STATUS REPORTING

The consolidated project status report will provide a single management view across:

Control Area	Reported Position
Scope	Baseline status, approved changes and emerging scope threats
Schedule	Milestone status, variance and upcoming critical activities
Deliverables	Completed, active, delayed and outstanding outputs

Control Area	Reported Position
Risks	High/critical risks, trend and response status
Dependencies	Active, approaching, delayed and blocked dependencies
Issues	Open material issues and resolution status
Resources	Capacity constraints and resource requirements
Decisions	Decisions made, pending and escalated
Quality	Validation status, defects and acceptance position
Value	Progress toward defined patient and operational outcomes

6. DECISION MANAGEMENT

Material decisions will be documented through a controlled Decision Log.

\	Requirement
Decision ID	Unique reference
Decision Required	Specific decision requiring resolution
Context	Relevant project circumstances
Options	Alternatives considered
Recommendation	Preferred option and rationale
Decision Authority	Authorised decision-maker
Decision	Approved outcome
Decision Date	Date resolved
Project Impact	Scope, schedule, resource, risk, quality or value implications
Action Required	Implementation activity
Action Owner	Accountable owner
Status	Open / Approved / Implemented

Decision principle:

Information → Analysis → Recommendation → Decision → Action → Record

7. ESCALATION MANAGEMENT

Escalation will be based on impact and decision authority, not simply issue age.



An issue will be escalated when it exceeds the authority, resources or capability available at the current management level, or materially threatens the items shown alongside the escalation path above.

8. ESCALATION LEVELS

Level	Condition	Decision Authority	Response
L1 — Workstream	Contained within one workstream	Workstream Lead	<i>Resolve and record</i>
L2 — Project	Cross-workstream impact	Project Manager	<i>Coordinate resolution</i>
L3 — Governance	Material impact on baseline or project performance	Project Sponsor / Leadership	<i>Formal intervention</i>
L4 — Strategic	Threat to project viability, major risk or fundamental scope decision	Project Leadership	<i>Strategic decision / re-baseline</i>

9. INFORMATION CONTROL

Project information will be classified according to its sensitivity and intended audience.

Information Category	Control Requirement
General Project Information	May be shared with relevant project participants
Internal Project Information	Restricted to authorised project stakeholders
Sensitive Project Information	Access limited to designated personnel
Patient-Related Information	Controlled access and approved handling procedures
AI / Data Governance Information	Shared with relevant assurance and decision authorities

Patient-identifiable information will not be included in routine project reporting unless its use is authorised, necessary and appropriately controlled.

10. COMMUNICATION RECORDS

The Project Management function will maintain the following controlled records:

- Communication Matrix
- Project Status Reports
- Meeting Records
- Action Log
- Decision Log
- Risk Register
- Dependency Register
- Issue Log
- Change Log

- Stakeholder Feedback
- Stage-Gate Decisions
- Approval Records

These records provide the project with a traceable management history from issue identification through decision and resolution.

11. COMMUNICATION RESPONSIBILITIES

Responsibility	Accountable Function
Maintain communication framework	Project Management
Consolidate project status	Project Management
Provide accurate workstream updates	Workstream Leads
Report emerging risks and dependencies	All Workstream Leads
Maintain decision records	Project Management
Escalate material deviations	Project Manager
Provide specialist information	Relevant Workstream Lead
Validate stakeholder requirements	Relevant Workstream + Project Management
Control sensitive information	Responsible Data / AI Governance
Confirm major project decisions	Project Sponsor / Leadership

12. COMMUNICATION PERFORMANCE

Communication effectiveness will be assessed against:

- **Timeliness** — information reaches decision-makers before action is required.
- **Accuracy** — reported information reflects the current project position.
- **Completeness** — material risks, dependencies, decisions and changes are visible.
- **Traceability** — significant decisions and approvals can be verified.
- **Responsiveness** — escalated matters receive appropriate action.
- **Alignment** — stakeholders receive information relevant to their authority and responsibilities.

13. COMMUNICATION CONTROL BASELINE

Communication Model	Structured, audience-specific and exception-driven
Primary Control Function	Project Management
Reporting Basis	Scope, schedule, risks, dependencies, issues, quality and value
Primary Governance Mechanisms	Status Reporting, Decision Log, Escalation and Stage Gates
Standard Review Cadence	Weekly project control
Exception Reporting	Immediate / as required
Sensitive Information Control	Need-to-know + authorised channels
Baseline Version	1.0
Next Review	Following initial stakeholder engagement

End of Communication Management Approach